

Development Banks (विकास बैंकहरू) in Nepal

Definition / परिभाषा: Development Banks (Class "B" Financial Institutions) मुख्य रूपमा **long-term project financing** र **economic development** को लागि स्थापना भएका बैंकहरू हुन्।

Commercial Banks जस्तो general deposit-ra short-term loan भन्दा यिनीहरूले **infrastructure, agriculture, industry, tourism** जस्ता विकासात्मक क्षेत्रमा विशेष लगानी गर्छन्। NRB ले यिनलाई Class B मा वर्गीकृत गरेको छ।

Role and Contribution (भूमिका र योगदान):

- **Regional Development:** Rural र underdeveloped क्षेत्रमा credit पहुँच पुऱ्याउने। Commercial banks भन्दा बढी province-level operation।
- **Priority Sector Lending:** Agriculture, SME (Small Medium Enterprise), renewable energy, infrastructure project मा loan।
- **Economic Growth:** Job creation, poverty reduction, balanced regional development।
- Nepal मा यिनीहरूले deprived sector lending को target पूरा गर्न पनि मद्दत गर्छन्।

Current Status (अहिलेको अवस्था): NRB data अनुसार (mid-2024 सम्म) नेपालमा १७+

Development Banks छन् (national र province level)। Paid-up capital र working area अनुसार classify। केही उदाहरण:

- Nirdhan Utthan Development Bank
- Agricultural Development Bank (ADB) - कृषि क्षेत्रमा मुख्य
- अन्य: Sana Kisan Bikas Bank, आदि।

Key Features / विशेषताहरू:

- **Capital Requirement:** Commercial Bank भन्दा कम तर Microfinance भन्दा बढी।
- **Lending Focus:** Medium to long-term loans (project loan), equity participation।
- **Deposit Collection:** Limited public deposit, मुख्य रूपमा institutional fund र refinance from NRB।
- **Regulation:** Bank and Financial Institutions Act 2073 अनुसार NRB supervision। Prudential norms (CRR, CDR, Loan Loss Provisioning) लागू।

- **Advantages:** Targeted development, lower risk concentration in one sector।
- **Challenges:** Higher NPL (Non-Performing Loan) risk project failure भएमा, limited branch network, competition with Commercial Banks।

History in Nepal:

- १९९० को दशकमा liberalization पछि विकास।
- Regional Rural Development Banks (RRDBs) Grameen model बाट inspired भएर आए।
- Development Bank Act २०५२ ले legal framework दियो।
- अहिले BFIs merger पछि संख्या घटेको छ तर efficiency बढेको।

Comparison with Others (तुलना):

- **Vs Commercial Banks (Class A):** Development Banks ले broad deposit-ra general banking भन्दा specific development project मा focus।
- **Vs Finance Companies (Class C):** Development Banks ले ठूला infrastructure loan, Finance Companies ले consumer/vehicle loan।
- **Vs Microfinance (Class D):** Development Banks ले medium scale, Micro ले very small individual/group loan।

Legal Provisions:

- Nepal Rastra Bank ले Unified Directives जारी गर्छ।
- Deprived Sector Lending: Certain % loan यस्ता क्षेत्रमा।
- Supervision: NRB को Banking Supervision Department ले नियमित inspect गर्छ।

Recent Trends:

- Digital banking adoption, green financing (environment friendly project), province-level expansion।
- Merger र acquisition पछि stronger capital base।

Exam Preparation Tips (परिक्षा तयारी):

- **5 Marks Question:** Define Development Banks र role explain गर्नुहोस्।

- **Example + Nepal Context** दिनुहोस् (जस्तै: ADB को कृषि contribution)।
- MCQ मा: Class B हो, development focus, आदि सोधिन सक्छ।
- Diagram/Image: Organizational structure or loan distribution pie-chart NRB annual report मा खोज्नुहोस्। Google मा "Nepal Development Banks list NRB" वा "Class B BFIs Nepal diagram" search गर्नुहोस्।

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